

Atrypa*Ancient shellfish***Type of organism**

Brachiopod

Geological period

Early Silurian to Late Devonian

Age range 440–372 million years old**Location** Worldwide

Brachiopods have a long history, appearing about 500 million years ago and still found alive today. They look like small clams, with two shells hinged together. This ancient brachiopod may have lived attached to the seabed by a fleshy stalk.

**Gallimimus***Birdlike reptile***Type of organism**

Theropod dinosaur

Geological period

Late Cretaceous

Age range

72–66 million years old

Location Mongolia

This is the skull of an ostrichlike dinosaur. It had a long, blunt, toothless beak that it probably used to prey on small animals, but it may have eaten some plants too. Its big eyes were protected by rings of small bones.



▼ **BIG BIRD**
Gallimimus lived in the same era as Tyrannosaurus rex.

Ammonite*Shelled squid***Type of organism** Cephalopod mollusk**Geological period** Devonian to Cretaceous**Age range** 420–66 million years old**Location** Worldwide

Distantly related to the nautilus that still lives in tropical oceans, ammonites were tentacled mollusks that lived in much the same way as modern cuttlefish. Fossils of their coiled shells are very common, and are a useful “index fossil” for dating rocks. Some were large, with shells that measured 6.5 ft (2 m) across.

▲ **SPIRAL SHELL**

This image shows the fossil shell's chambers.

Megalodon tooth*Deadly weapon***Type of organism** Shark tooth**Geological period** Miocene to Pliocene**Age range** 23–2.6 million years old**Location** Worldwide

This is the tooth of an extinct relative of the great white shark called *Carcharodon megalodon*. The tooth of a great white is up to 2.7 in (7 cm) long, but this is more than twice as big! This huge shark preyed on mammals such as whales and dolphins.

**Dicroidium***Fossil leaf***Type of organism**

Seed fern

Geological period

Triassic

Age range 252–208 million years old**Location** Southern hemisphere

Dicroidium is one of an extinct group of plants that looked like ferns. It bore seeds instead of the simple spores produced by true ferns. It dates from the period when dinosaurs first appeared, and it is likely that this flora formed part of their diet.

**Mammoth tusk***Ice-age relic***Type of organism** Mammal tooth**Geological period** Pliocene to Holocene**Age range** 5 million to 3,600 years old**Location** North America, northern Eurasia

Their long tusks are the most spectacular remains of the massive mammoths, which roamed the northern continents during the last ice age. Whole mammoths are sometimes found frozen in the Arctic permafrost with their skin and hair intact.

▼ **MIGHTY TOOTH**

Mammoth tusks were curved. The longest could reach up to 14 ft (4.2 m).

